DevExpress v26.1 Update — Your Feedback Matters

Our What's New in v26.1 webpage includes product-specific surveys. Your response to our survey questions will help us measure product satisfaction for features released in this major update and help us refine our plans for our next major release.

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How To: Create a File Explorer

Nov 13, 2018 • 5 minutes to read

This example demonstrates how to use the **Breadcrumb Edit** control to create a file navigation bar, similar to the one seen in Microsoft Windows Explorer. Two nodes (*Root* and *Computer*) are created at design-time as persistent nodes, always visible to an end-user. Their `BreadCrumbNode.Persistent` and `BreadCrumbNode.PopulateOnDemand` properties must be set to **true**. The *Root* node stores shortcuts to most important directories (Desktop, Windows, Program Files). The *Computer* node allows end-users to quickly navigate through local disks via related shortcuts. The Nodes tree is dynamically generated at runtime according to the current directories hierarchy. To do so, the `RepositoryItemBreadCrumbEdit.ValidatePath`, `RepositoryItemBreadCrumbEdit.NewNodeAdding` and `RepositoryItemBreadCrumbEdit.QueryChildNodes` events are handled.

View Example

Form1.cs

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```
using DevExpress.XtraEditors;
using DevExpress.XtraEditors.Repository;

namespace FileNavigator {
    public partial class Form1 : XtraForm {
        public static readonly int MaxEntitiesCount = 80;
        public Form1() {
            InitializeComponent();
            Initialize();
        }

        void myItem_Click(object sender, EventArgs e) {
            throw new NotImplementedException();
        }

        void Properties_QueryPopUp(object sender, CancelEventArgs e) {
            throw new NotImplementedException();
        }


        //Set the Breadcrumb Editor's initial path
        void Initialize() {
            breadCrumbEdit1.Path = Environment.GetFolderPath(Environment.SpecialFolder
            foreach (DriveInfo driveInfo in GetFixedDrives()) {
                breadCrumbEdit1.Properties.History.Add(new BreadCrumbHistoryItem(drive
            }
        }

        private void breadCrumbEdit1_Properties_NewNodeAdding(object sender, DevExpres
            e.Node.PopulateOnDemand = true;
        }

        //Check whether or not the target path exists
        private void breadCrumbEdit1_Properties_ValidatePath(object sender, DevExpress
            if (!Directory.Exists(e.Path)) {
                e.ValidationResult = DevExpress.XtraEditors.BreadCrumbValidatePathResu
                return;
```

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```
            return;
        }
        //Populate dynamic nodes
        string dir = e.Node.Path;
        if (!Directory.Exists(dir))
            return;
        string[] subDirs = GetSubFolders(dir);
        for (int i = 0; i < subDirs.Length; i++) {
            e.Node.ChildNodes.Add(CreateNode(subDirs[i]));
        }
    }

    void InitBreadCrumbRootNode(BreadCrumbNode node) {
        node.ChildNodes.Add(new BreadCrumbNode("Desktop", Environment.GetFolderPat
        node.ChildNodes.Add(new BreadCrumbNode("Windows", Environment.GetFolderPat
        node.ChildNodes.Add(new BreadCrumbNode("Program Files", Environment.GetFol
    }
    void InitBreadCrumbComputerNode(BreadCrumbNode node) {
        foreach (DriveInfo driveInfo in GetFixedDrives()) {
            node.ChildNodes.Add(new BreadCrumbNode(driveInfo.Name, driveInfo.RootD
        }
    }

    protected BreadCrumbNode CreateNode(string path) {
        string folderName = new DirectoryInfo(path).Name;
        return new BreadCrumbNode(folderName, folderName, true);
    }

    //Get the local drives list
    public static IEnumerable<DriveInfo> GetFixedDrives() {
        foreach (DriveInfo driveInfo in DriveInfo.GetDrives()) {
            if (driveInfo.DriveType != DriveType.Fixed) continue;
            yield return driveInfo;
        }
    }

    //Get all subfolders contained within the target directory
```

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```
            string[] subDirs = null;
            try {
                subDirs = Directory.GetDirectories(dir, "*", SearchOption.TopDirectory
            }
            catch { }
            return subDirs;
        }

        private void breadCrumbEdit1_PathChanged(object sender, BreadCrumbPathChangedE
            label2.Text = breadCrumbEdit1.Path;
        }

        private void breadCrumbEdit1_Properties_PathChanged(object sender, BreadCrumbP

        }
    }
}
```

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